

The absorption level is a choice of comparator — and the one estimated from data puts it at zero

Top row: the baseline the design started from — asserted, not estimated. Bottom row: the baseline estimated from data — the comparator with standing. Filled markers mark a 95% bootstrap interval (B = 2000, resampled by utterance) that excludes zero; open markers one that covers it. The comparator and the population it is applied to change together, and §13 records that the population is not a detail but the whole result: the assumed comparator is measured on the paired subset (89–230 of the 416 utterances per cell), the calibrated null over the full degraded sample (416).

